ÖZÜM Design Milestones

IDE438.A

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Process Steps

Background Research
Benefit Areas

Target Group Definition
Brand Branchmark

Technical Feasibility
Use Scenario Critique
Concept Critique
“Nesting Ritual” Concept
Transforming Into a Service

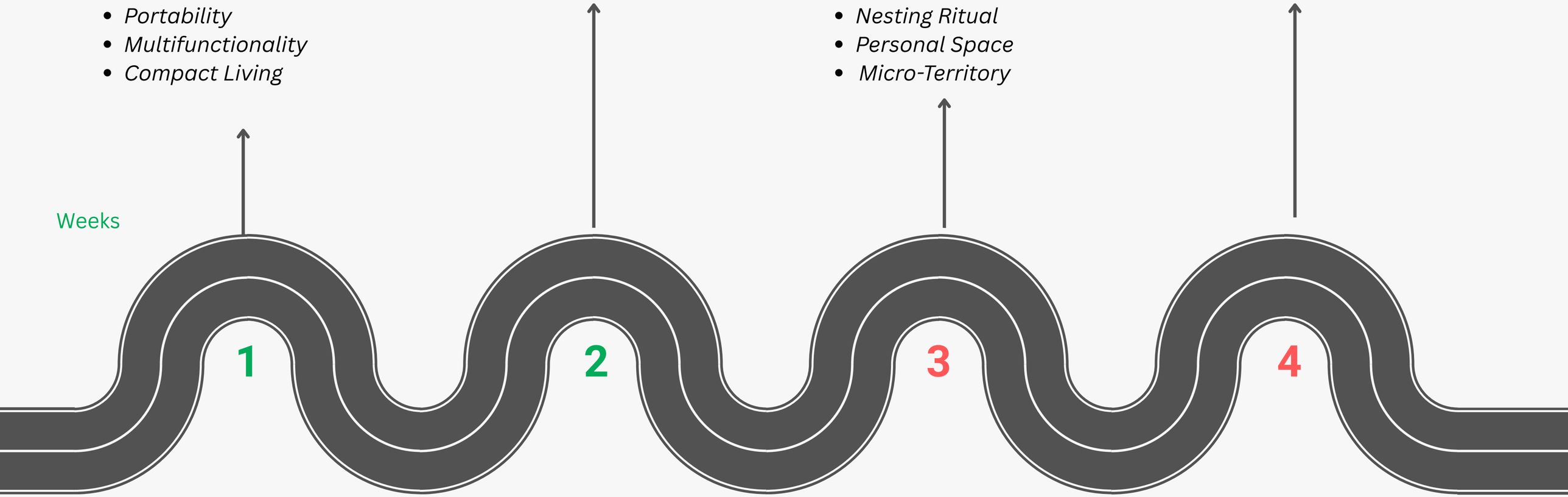
Opportunity Areas
Defined context and concept
Modelling

Keywords

- *Portability*
- *Multifunctionality*
- *Compact Living*

- *Nesting Ritual*
- *Personal Space*
- *Micro-Territory*

Weeks



Clarifier

Helped refine target groups and usage scenarios.

“Also, how is the arrangement in terms of usability? And how are thermoses placed in other compartments with a difference of minutes or seconds for use with kettles?”

“What material should I use to make the thermos so that when I place the thermos on top of the kettle, the user can easily remove the thermos with their hand after it boils without burning their hand?”

Re-framer

Shifted focus from feature-level (speed, space-saving) to meaning-level (ritual, autonomy).

Would it be better, easier and safer to charge a kettle and use it as a student or a worker who wants to be practical or would it better if they use it with a cable that they can carry. Is the charger a great way and how long could it be used for, is it needed?

"Actually, focusing on the individual meaning and space saving makes more sense. I really like Stanley's approach to this project."

Expander

Suggested opportunity areas (hygiene, decluttering, CMF hybridization).

“What are the opportunity areas for my 2-in-1 kettle-mug?”

"I am designing a kettle for students who have just started staying in dormitories, aiming to evoke feelings of warmth and belonging. At the same time, I want to transform this product into a service. In which ways and contexts could I do this?"

Critique

Identified potential pain points in the daily ritual and proposed refinements for the technical execution.

“Could you comment on and critique this in terms of usage, service and the moment of use?”

"I don't want RFID; instead, I want the thermos holder and its base to fit together... I thought this system could work, so the kettle wouldn't be too big, and everyone would be responsible for their own drink. Criticize this."

AI Response Summaries

Week 1

Identified existing kettle strengths (speed, safety, efficiency) and improvement areas.
Opportunities: It has been determined that current designs focus only on boiling or complex digital features, highlighting a need for portable and multifunctional products.

Week 2

Mapped target groups and analyzed the decorative positioning of idealized kettles versus the functional differentiation needed for this project.

Week 3

During the AI feedback session, the project's strategic depth was increased, transforming it from just a "2-in-1 water heater" into a "personal micro-ritual system."
Strategic Focus: Even if the technology becomes perfected (boiling in seconds), the focus is on the concepts of "belonging, control, and personal boundaries," which will retain their value.

Week 4

In the final stage of the project, a "shared service" model was developed for dormitory environments where individual kettle use is prohibited.
Shared Heating Station: A central heating station was designed in the common kitchens, capable of serving 3 students simultaneously.
Personal Thermos: Personal thermoses, mechanically compatible with the station (with a locking mechanism), are given as orientation gifts by the universities; they both ensure hygiene and become a symbol of belonging.

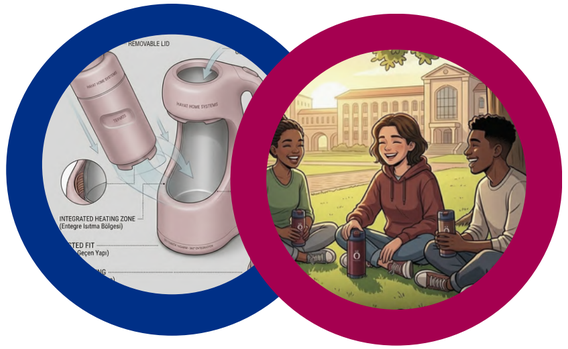
REFLECTIONS

Product to Service

What began as a personal electric kettle concept evolved into a Shared Heating Station model to navigate dormitory safety regulations and address broader user needs.

Feature to Meaning

Through AI-driven critique, the project moved beyond "boiling water faster" to creating a personal micro-ritual that establishes autonomy and emotional grounding for first-year students in shared environments.

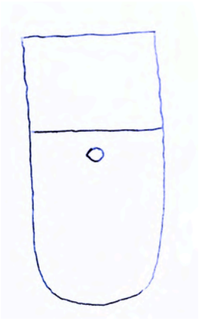


The "Nesting Ritual" & Belonging

The decision to use a nesting system—where the kettle acts as a spatial anchor and the mug as a portable extension—strengthens the user's sense of belonging both at their desk, common kitchen and during their mobile daily routine.

Week 1

Identified kettle strengths (speed, safety, efficiency) and improvement areas (sustainability, smart features)



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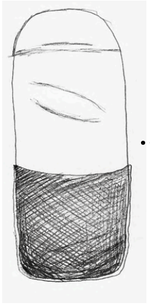
Week 2

Mapped target groups (students, workers, travelers) and analyzed idealized kettles decorative positioning vs. project's functional differentiation.

Week 3.1

Compared rechargeable vs. cabled kettles → cable preferred for practicality, safety and weight.

Introduced "Nesting Ritual" scenario → seamless boiling-to-drinking transition.



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Shared Station Service

Week 3.2

Critiqued project as feature-level, urged reframing toward ritual, autonomy and personal space.

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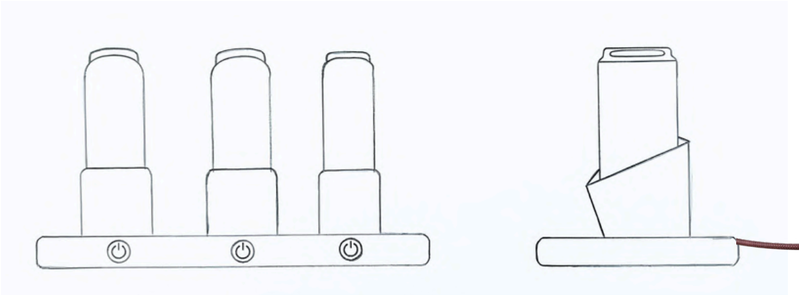
Week 4

Following the definition of the context and concept, the product was refined through critical feedback on user scenarios, specifically targeting the 'pre-class rush' and shared kitchen dynamics following a service model where thermoses are distributed during orientation days.



DESIGN DECISIONS

Accepted	Rejected	Transformed
Cable powered heating	Rechargeable battery kettle	From “functional kettle-mug” → to “personal ritual system.”
Nested 2-in-1 design	Overly broad user definition (students + workers + travelers	From “time-saving device” → to “micro-territory object” that supports autonomy and belonging.
Focus on portability and multifunctionality	Student ID reading with RFID	From a ‘’personal desk kettle’’ → to ‘’common area service’’
A safe heating system through ceramic glass coating	Large water tank in the station	

“This project is not just about boiling water faster. It is about creating a compact personal ritual system that empowers students to reclaim autonomy, hygiene and belonging in shared or pressured environments.”

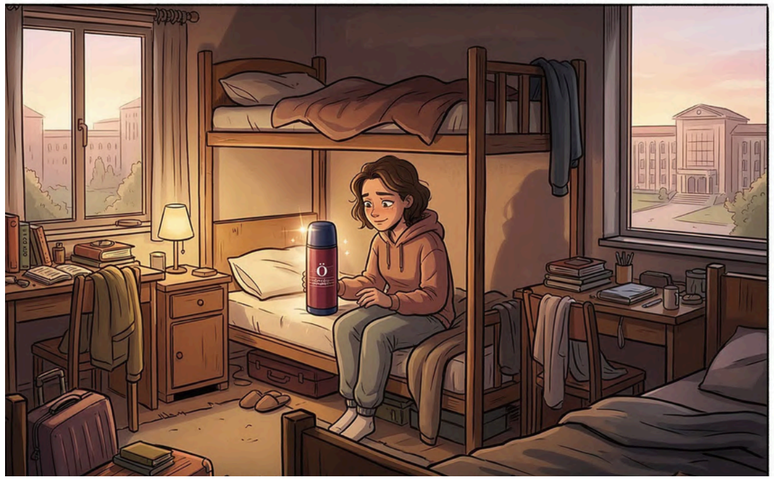
RENDERS

ALTERNATIVE

USER SCENARIO

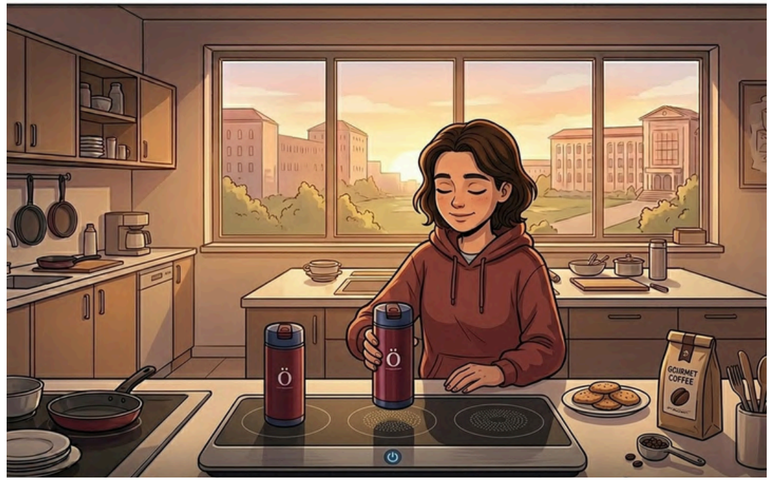
The first gift, the first sense of belonging. Meeting Özyeğin's burgundy and navy blue colors and taking that first warm step into your new home on campus.

Eylül has just moved into the dorm. While looking at a photo of her family, she feels homesick and utterly alone.



Eylül notices the thermos on her desk, the one handed out during orientation. This little gift reminds her that she's a part of the school and awakens a faint sense of hope within her.

Eylül goes to the communal kitchen with her thermos where she runs into other students. The thermos sparks a quick conversation.



Eylül has now made it a routine to go to the kitchen every morning before class and fill her thermos with coffee or tea using the kettle.

Eylül is sitting on the campus lawn with her friends. They all have thermoses in their hands and are laughing. Eylül's face reflects a complete sense of belonging and happiness.